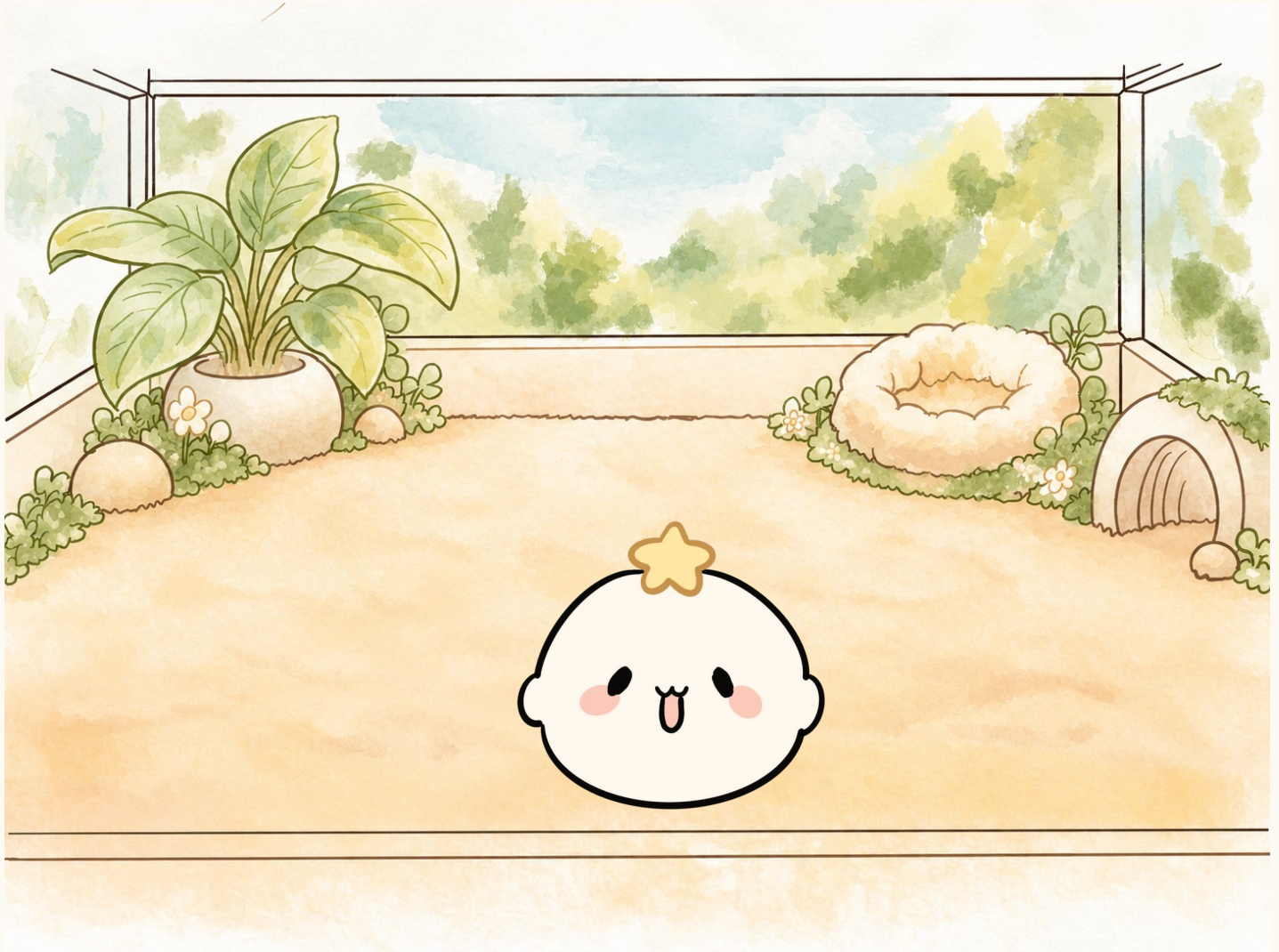
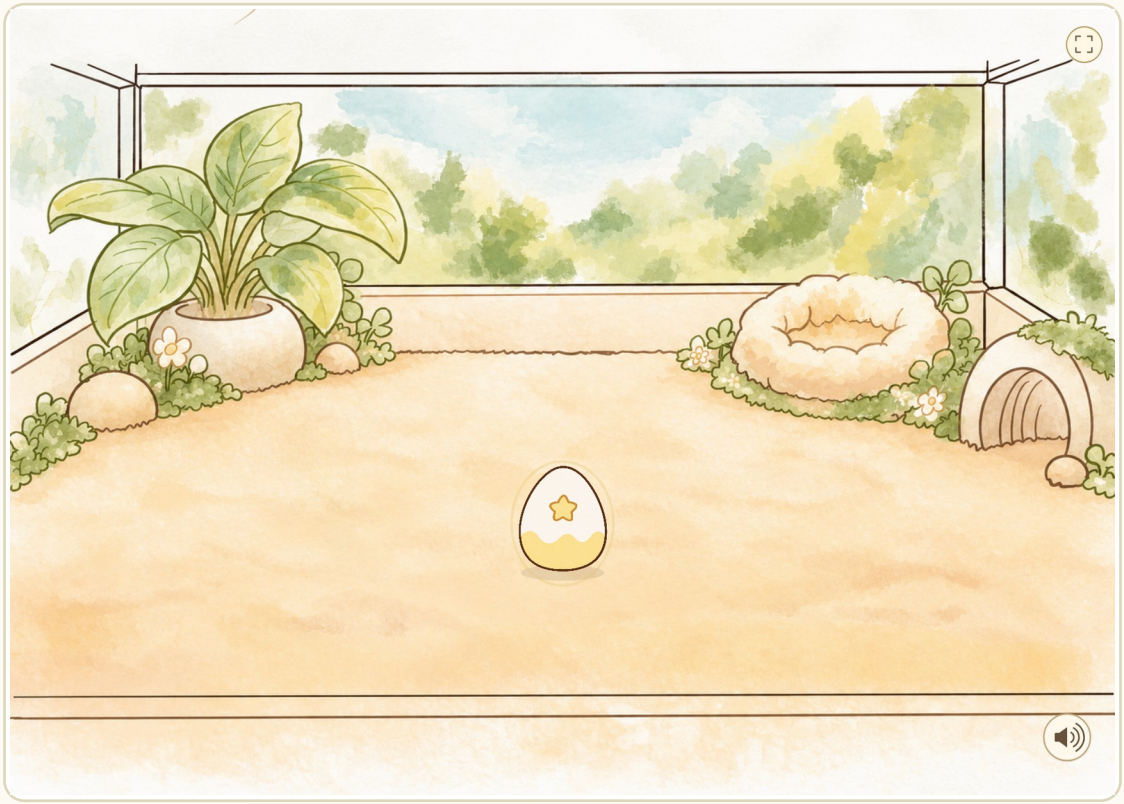
Little Rascal

Caring for a small creature, learning when to let it go.

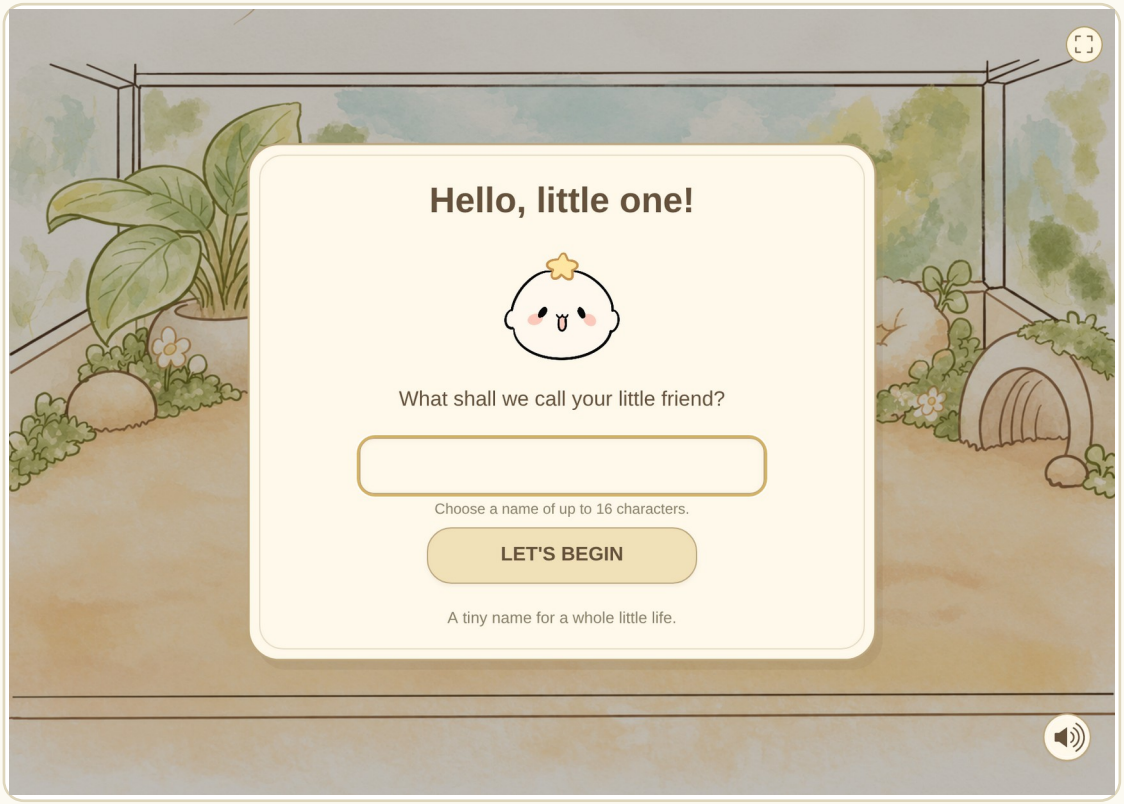


Documentation & reflection · p5.js

What does a visitor notice first?



A moving egg invites a click



Naming makes the meeting personal

Proposed setting: computer + mouse + headphones. Toy discovery remains untested.

Two minutes inside the room

00:00–00:25

Egg, arrival, naming

00:25–00:55

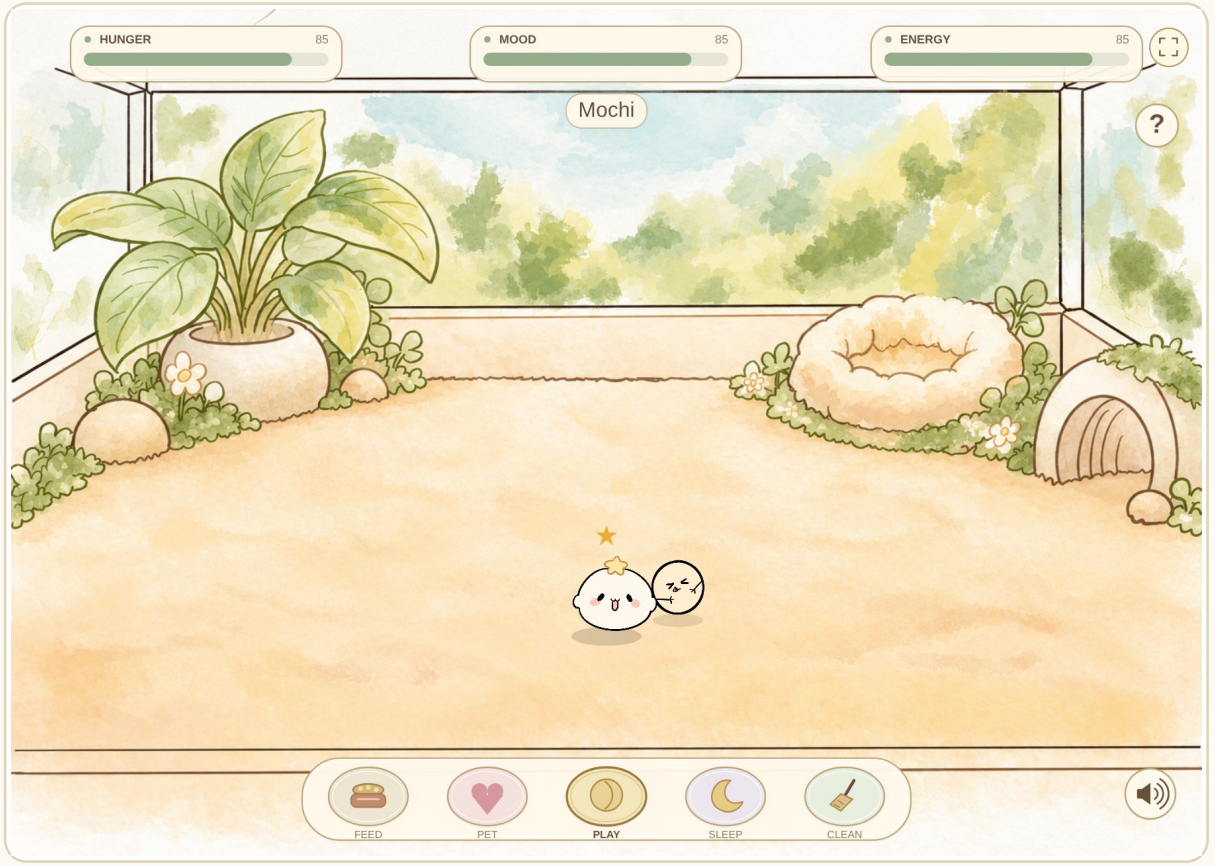
Care, throw, contact kick

00:55–01:20

Youth reactions and needs

01:20–02:00

Senior, farewell, new egg



RECORDING PLAN · Insert a 2-minute gameplay edit here.

Cuts between life stages must be visible. No video is embedded.

Why care might become attachment

01

VISCERAL

A soft room and a simple face invite the first approach.

02

BEHAVIOURAL

Care produces a readable response: smile, refusal, kick.

03

REFLECTIVE

A familiar pet ages;
a letter reframes earlier care.

Intended emotions: affection → responsibility → gentle loss.

Norman (2004). Design interpretation, not a measured audience outcome.

Four stages became three: a shorter visit

EARLIER: LITTLE ONE → TEENAGER → ADULT → SENIOR



LITTLE ONE

3 useful feeds + 3 pettings

Then sleep and wake



YOUTH

2 useful feeds + 2 care actions

Then sleep and wake



SENIOR

Slower hops, rest and affection

Then natural farewell

Four → three stages shortens the visit. A new egg begins the next cycle.

Play needed a visible point of contact

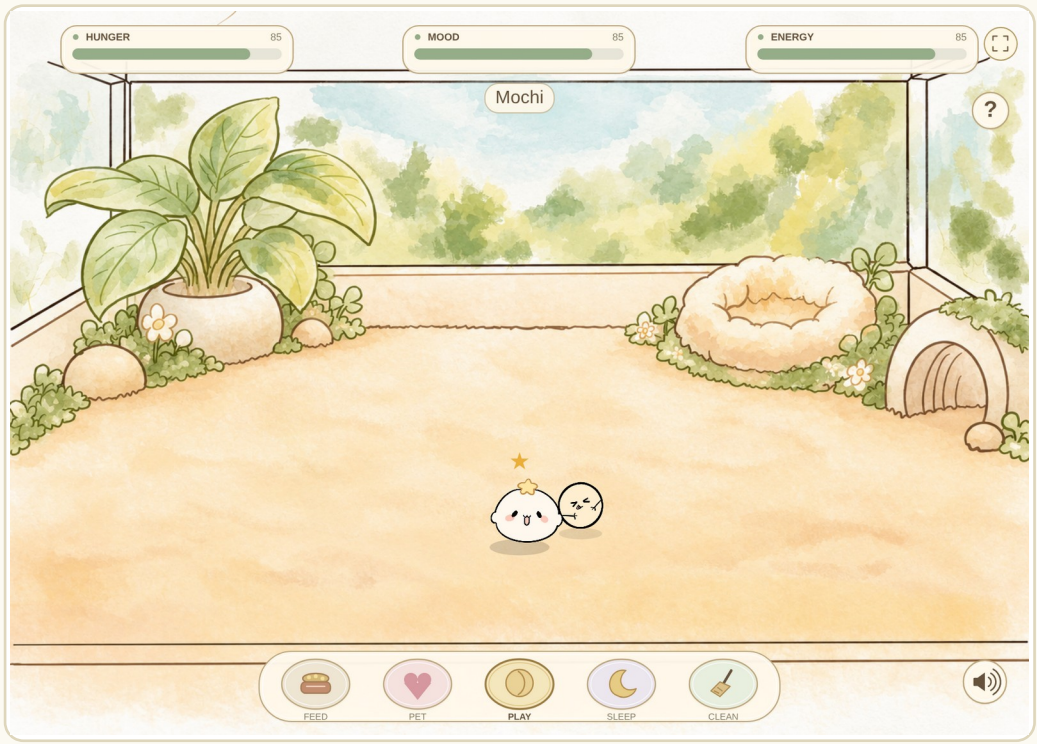
EARLIER · AUTHOR PLAYTHROUGH

Button-led play.

Pursuit looked disconnected.

Running felt too fast.

CURRENT · ACTUAL GAME



Throw → approach → contact → small kick + call

Comparison text comes from development feedback; image shows the current version.

Youth does not always say yes



ACCEPTS

Useful care gets a response.



UNIMPRESSED

Repetition or a full need.



ANGRY REFUSAL

25% baseline chance.

A boundary can feel like personality — or a broken button.

Critical-mood petting remains available. Refusal can lower mood.

Older, slower, and more attached

EARLIER

Slower playback felt artificial.

Grounded walking lost the bounce.

CURRENT

Three slower, small hops.

Then ~3 seconds fully still.

WHY IT MATTERS

Slower movement; a stronger need for the player’s affection.



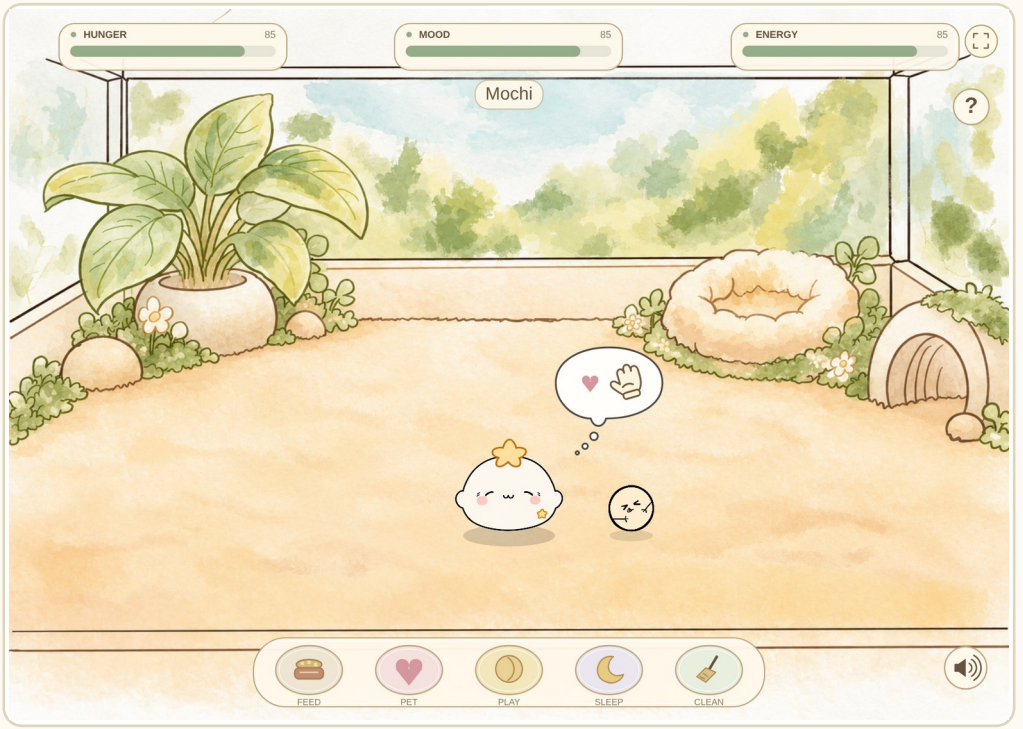
Youth sometimes pulls away. Senior actively asks for petting, three times across its older life.

A body can explain what a bar cannot



HUNGER BELOW 30

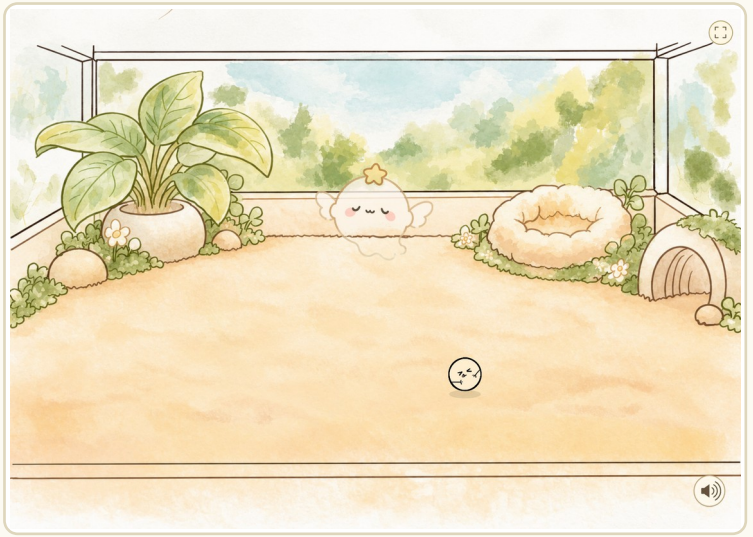
Keep the bar; add a bodily expression.



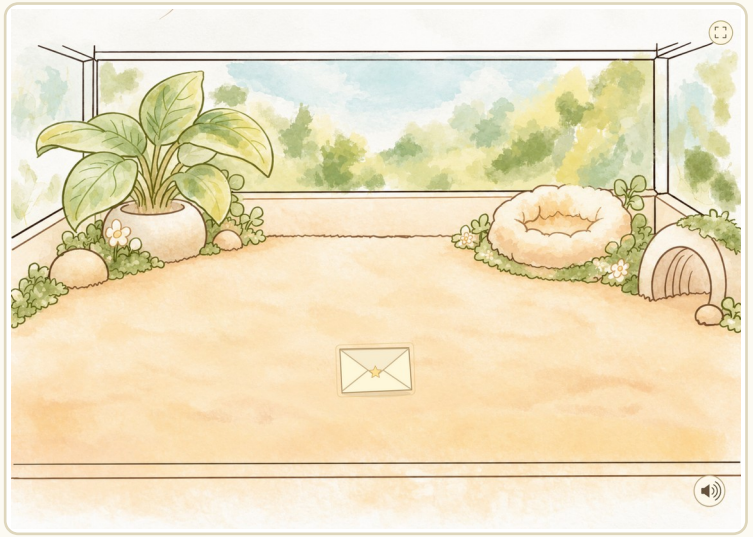
Tutor suggestion: clearer needs + sound. Existing hunger pose retained; affection bubble added.

Petting · anger · crying onset · contact kick · idle hum. Speaker controls BGM only.

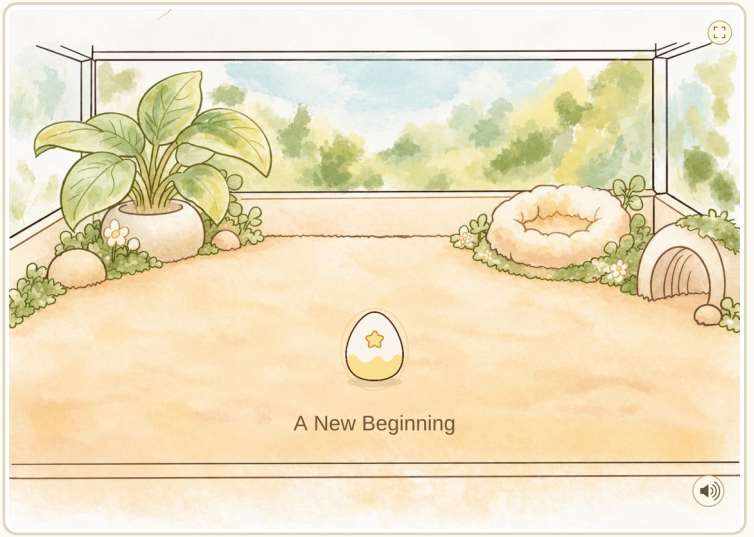
Farewell becomes a new beginning



The body dissolves



The player opens the envelope



Starlight becomes a new egg

Birth → growth → farewell → starlight → a new egg

Natural old age only. Neglect keeps the earlier result screen and restart.

What the feedback actually tells me

DOCUMENTED	My own playthrough feedback	Remote-looking chase; rushed hatch; aging felt like slow motion.
REPORTED BY DESIGNER	Tutor advice	Add sound; make needs clearer through visual cues such as bubbles.
REPORTED BY DESIGNER	Peer suggestions	Background music; more interactive toy; richer expressions and hungry pose.

Consequences are part of caring

RESPONSIBILITY

Keeping the pet alive
requires repeated care.

INTENDED CHALLENGE

Neglect can be fatal.
Attention has consequences.

Waste: smell at 6 seconds; illness death at 13 seconds total.

Test the warning and recovery time — keep the stakes.

What I would test next

01 OBSERVE

First-time play without coaching.
Watch discovery and misunderstandings.

02 COMPARE

Current cues vs clearer cues;
current warning time vs a longer one.

03 ASK & REVISE

Ask what players understood.
Test the revised three-stage duration.

Future possibilities: saved progress and separate voice controls. Neither is currently implemented.

A little life, then another beginning

Birth. Care. Growth.
Farewell. A new beginning.



One life ends; another begins. What remains is the care.

PLAY LITTLE RASCAL ↗️

itsangelia.github.io/little-rascal/

References & source notes

FRAMEWORK	Norman, D. A. (2004). Emotional design: Why we love (or hate) everyday things. Basic Books.
TECHNICAL LIBRARY	Processing Foundation. (n.d.). p5.js reference. https://p5js.org/reference/
ASSESSMENT	Curtin University. (n.d.). GRDE2040 Assignment Two: Emotional Interactions [brief]; A2 Playful Exhibition [rubric]. User-supplied course documents.
PLAY REFERENCE	My Lil' Bastard — user-supplied gameplay video/screenshots. Publisher, year and exact source require confirmation.
PROJECT SOURCE	Little Rascal. Source: https://github.com/itsangelia/little-rascal Gameplay baseline: d3ab74f. Images show current staged game states, not audience footage.
MEDIA CREDITS	User-uploaded illustrations and AI-assisted visual iterations. BGM: Pixabay (designer-reported; track / artist / URL to add). Pet voice: recorded by the designer, then excerpted for the game.

Author–date draft: check the exact reference style required by the unit outline.

AI assistance & submission record

DRAFT DISCLOSURE · AUTHOR MUST VERIFY

OpenAI ChatGPT/Codex assisted with ideation, visual explorations, coding, debugging, audio excerpt processing, and editing slides and narration.

The designer confirms tutor approval for AI assistance. The record documents their selections, rejected options and repeated revisions. Personal analysis must be checked and expressed in their own words.

Submission checks	AI scope declaration · music track credit · feedback given to a peer Curtin cover sheet · video link + timestamp · source link · required filename

AI permission and voice authorship are designer-reported; no formal audience study is claimed.